

Reports: The Return by Reg Cribb

Each group is required to present a report to the class on their section of the play. This will be in detailed note form with brief quotes from the text to prove your points. Each member of the group will cover a different aspect or convention of stage drama (themes, characterisation, setting, language style, and dramatic style). Follow the guide questions below to help you in your report. Your group also needs to include a detailed section summary (plot) and key quotes (with page number).

Make a copy of your report as a handout for each member of the class to follow while you present and to be handed in to the teacher (one A4 page per student plus a cover page).

Group Number	Section of text to cover
1.	Pages 1- 9
2.	Pages 10 - 19
3.	Pages 20 - 29
4.	Pages 30 -39
5.	Pages 40 - 48

Guide Questions on the Ingredients of Stage Drama

Themes

- What are the main 'issues' being explored?
- What attitudes and values does the playwright have towards the issues he or she is exploring?
- What is the dominant reading? Is there a resistant or minority reading?
- What conflicts and struggles are being explored?
- What parts of human nature are being presented?
- Are there also 'cultural/social issues' being examined?
- Explain the significance of the main events
- More detail
 - Intellectual: does the viewer become involved intellectually in the themes?
 - Emotions: discuss why the viewer reacts in the manner he/she does. What is the dominant reading emotionally? Can you give a resistant reading? Is the reader involved emotionally with certain characters, in specific experiences? Is empathy, sympathy, admiration, fear, disgust, pity etc evoked? Do the viewer's feelings change? When? Why?
 - Playwright: what is the playwright's world view?

Characterisation

The **protagonist** is the central character of the play. This character is at the centre of the conflict and often undergoes radical changes during the course of the play. The **antagonist** is the character who opposes the main character. Some plays also include a **foil**, a minor character whose traits contrast sharply with those of the main character. The interplay among these characters heightens the dramatic tension as the play develops.

- What does the viewer learn about the main characters?
- Do you like the characters? Are we sympathetic to them?
- What are their motivations (their reasons for doing things)?
- Their strong and weak points
- Do the characters change or develop over your section of the play?
- Are the characters 'complex' or 'contradictory'?
- Are males and females portrayed stereotypically?
- Are characters confined or defined by class, race, gender, sexuality, religion?

Setting

- The set – described at the start of the scene in italics.
- Sub-worlds – microcosms – contained little worlds within the larger set.
- Effect of setting on characters – comfort zones, sympathy with setting.
- Compare moods created, light, shade (darkness), smells, sounds.
- Effect of setting on audience (mood, themes etc).
- Props – symbolism – how do props help create setting and mood?
- Scene changes – contrasting settings.

Language Style

- How does the playwright tell his story? How is it structured? Who speaks? How do they speak?
- Discuss imagery, symbolism, alliterations, metaphor, simile, allegory, analogy, emotive words, repetition, adverbs, adjectives.
- Discuss names of people and places.
- How is the tone or mood of the play achieved? Dialogue? Descriptions?
- What is the writer's attitude toward his characters? How do you know this?

Dramatic Style

- Visual imagery – costumes, props – symbols we see on stage.
- Stage and voice directions – italics and brackets.
- Non-verbal communications – ie. looks.
- Soliloquies (effect on audience). Monologues.
- Lighting.
- Dialogue – how do people speak?
- Scene changes.
- Sound effects.
- Actions.